

WEEK 5 • TNF REPORT CARD

BUCCANEERS 24, COWBOYS 16: OUR REPORT CARD

We checked our two pregame adjustments against the final box score and the play-by-play.

ADJUSTMENT 01 • THE GROUND GAME

6.2 YPC

TB RUSHING VS. 4.4 BENCHMARK

Tampa Bay ran 39 times for 241 yards. Irving had 165 on 21 carries.

● PREDICTION: HIT • TB SEASON-HIGH 241 RUSH YDS

ADJUSTMENT 02 • PRESSURE POINTS

1 SACK

DALLAS SACKS OF DANIELS

We said Dallas needed 4. It got 1. Prescott was not sacked.

● PREDICTION: MISS • THE BLITZ DECIDED IT

THE POSTGAME VERDICT

We read the run game right and the pass rush wrong.

Four of our six pregame benchmarks hit. Tampa Bay ran for 241 yards, held the ball 39:21, and did not turn it over. Dallas gave it away three times.

● 7-PAGE SLIDE DECK

THE GROUND GAME: HIT

THE GROUND GAME: WHAT HAPPENED

Tampa Bay beat its 4.4 pregame benchmark by 1.8 yards a carry against a Dallas front that allowed 4.8.

YARDS PER CARRY: TB WEEK 5 VS. DAL ALLOWED PREGAME

BUCCANEERS RUSHING, WEEK 5



39 CARRIES, 241 YARDS, 2 TD • BUCCANEERS.COM

COWBOYS RUSH D, ALLOWED THROUGH WEEK 4



126 CARRIES, 601 YARDS ALLOWED • NFL.COM

WHAT THE FILM SAYS

Tampa Bay ran for 241 yards, a season high

THE EDGE

Irving ran 21 times for 165 yards (7.9), with a 72-yard run to open the second half.

Next play: Egbuka's 14-yard TD run. Two plays, 86 yards, 1:00.

THE COUNTERPOINT

Dallas ran 13 times for 50 yards, 3.8 a carry, right at its season rate.

Tampa Bay's front allowed 3.8 after 3.2 pregame. Williams: 12 for 45, 1 TD.

VERDICT: HIT. TAMPA BAY'S 6.2 YARDS PER CARRY BEAT OUR 4.4 BENCHMARK

THE VERDICT:

Run-first was the right read for a rookie quarterback. The ground game set the script.

Tampa Bay held the ball 39:21 to Dallas's 20:39 and ran 65 plays to Dallas's 55.

THE RUN GAME ON FILM

THE FILM: HOW THE RUN GAME WON

Three sequences that show the ground game doing what our pregame blueprint said it should.

STEP 1 • FRONT-LOAD THE RUN

A 15-play, 73-yard drive answers Dallas's opener

After Dallas scored on its first drive, Tampa Bay held the ball 10:58 and tied it on Irving's 5-yard catch.

STEP 2 • THE SECOND-HALF SCRIPT

Irving's 72-yard run flips the game

Two plays, 86 yards, 1:00. Egbuka's 14-yard run put Tampa Bay ahead 14-10 and began a 17-point quarter.

STEP 3 • CLOSE IT OUT

Runs finish it after the Anzalone interception

With 1:22 left, Irving broke a long run on second down so Tampa Bay could kneel out the clock.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

241

TB RUSH YARDS

Season high, 39 carries

7-13

TB THIRD DOWNS

Benchmark was 4-for-12

23

DANIELS RUSH YDS

On 7 carries, 0 turnovers

WHAT IT MEANS: SHORT YARDAGE KEPT A ROOKIE OUT OF PASSING DOWNS

THE PASS RUSH: MISS

PRESSURE POINTS: WHAT HAPPENED

We expected Dallas to hit Daniels often. It got one sack, and Tampa Bay's line held up.

TAMPA BAY SACKS TAKEN: WEEK 5 VS. WEEKS 1-4 PER GAME

TB SACKS TAKEN, WEEK 5

1

1 SACK, 11 YARDS, 25 PASS ATTEMPTS • BUCCANEERS.COM

TB SACKS TAKEN PER GAME, WEEKS 1-4

4.0

16 SACKS IN 4 GAMES • NFL.COM

THE PRESSURE STORY

The blitz mattered more than the sacks

DALLAS'S PASS RUSH

One Dallas sack, 11 yards, in the third quarter. Our benchmark was 4.

A holding flag on Bland also erased a third-down sack on the first drive.

TAMPA BAY'S BLITZ

Prescott was 2 of 13 against the blitz through three quarters.

He finished 9 of 20. Tykee Smith had 5 pressures on 7 blitzes, per ESPN.

VERDICT: HALF MISS. DALLAS GOT 1 SACK, NOT 4, BUT TB ALLOWED JUST 1

THE MISS:

We named Dallas's pass rush the swing factor. Tampa Bay's blitz was the swing factor. Prescott threw 2 INTs and Turpin lost a fumble. Dallas had 3 turnovers and 0 takeaways.

THE PRESSURE ON FILM

THE FILM: WHERE WE MISSED

Three sequences that show why the pass-rush edge never showed up for Dallas.

STEP 1 • THE SACK THAT WASN'T

A holding flag erased Dallas's best chance

On the first drive, Dallas sacked Daniels on third-and-5. A holding call on DaRon Bland gave Tampa Bay a new set of downs.

STEP 2 • BLITZ BEATS THE QUICK GAME

Tampa Bay brought pressure, Dallas stalled

OLB David Walker's pressure forced an errant throw before halftime, and a tipped pass became Yaya Diaby's first career interception.

STEP 3 • THE TURNOVER SWING

Two turnovers built the lead; a third sealed it

Diaby's INT and Turpin's fumble led to 10 points. Anzalone's late pick ended it. DAL 3 turnovers, TB 0.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

1

DAL SACKS

Benchmark was 4

2 / 13

PRESCOTT VS. BLITZ

Through three quarters

3 / 0

DAL / TB GIVEAWAYS

2 INTs and 1 fumble for DAL

WHAT IT MEANS: PRESSURE WON THE GAME EVEN WITHOUT SACKS

THE VALIDATION SCORECARD

THE PREGAME SCORECARD, GRADED

We posted 3 metrics (6 benchmarks) before kickoff. Here is how each one finished.

METRIC 01 • SACKS

1 of 2 benchmarks hit

Dallas 4+ sacks: MISS (1). TB 2 or fewer allowed: HIT (1 allowed).

IF IT HOLDS: PASS ON PROTECTION, FAIL ON RUSH

METRIC 02 • YARDS PER CARRY

2 of 2 benchmarks hit

TB 4.4+: HIT (6.2). DAL 3.8+: HIT (3.8, 50 yards on 13 carries).

IF IT HOLDS: BOTH BENCHMARKS MET

METRIC 03 • THIRD DOWN

1 of 2 benchmarks hit

DAL 5-for-10: MISS (4-for-10). TB 4-for-12: HIT (7-for-13).

IF IT HOLDS: TAMPA BAY KEPT DRIVES ALIVE

FINAL GRADE: 4 OF 6

We nailed the run game and missed the pass rush.

Benchmarks are from our Week 5 pregame pack. Final stats: team sites and ESPN.



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REAL SCHEME. REAL DATA. ZERO HOT TAKES.

We replace narrative noise with schematic charting and film verification.

PILLAR 01

LIVE TACTICAL CHARTING

Real-time tracking of box counts, coverage shells, and pressure rates.

PILLAR 02

SECOND-HALF ADJUSTMENTS

Coordinator adjustments modeled during the halftime window.

PILLAR 03

ACCOUNTABLE FILM AUDITS

Every pregame projection is checked against the game film afterward.

JOIN THE DISCUSSION

Was Thursday a one-off for Tampa Bay, or the blueprint for a turnaround?

Tell us what you saw and which matchup we should audit next.

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